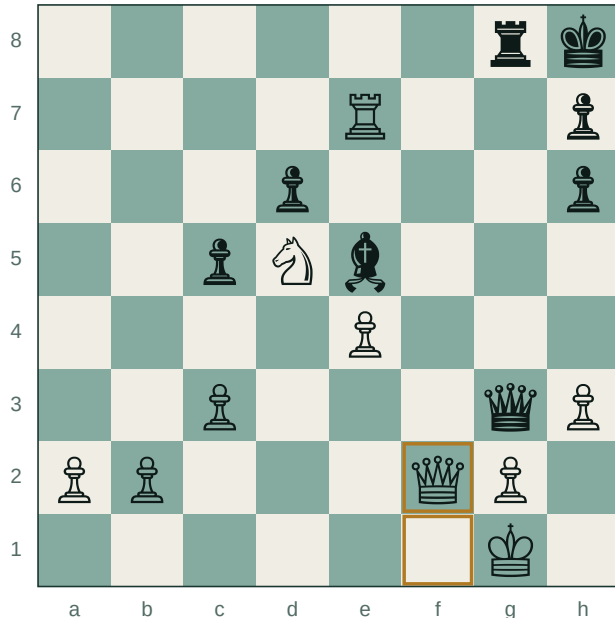


Deflection tactics: Black, move 36

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Qf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...Qh2+ 37. Kf1 Qh1+ 38. Ke2 Rxcg2

36...Qh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37.Kf1**.

37...Qh1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **38.Ke2**.

38...Rxcg2 The rook captures the pawn on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on g2.